

Setting the Scene. The Future of Work and Organisations

Session 1

Hello!

- Dr. Mary Parkinson

- In small groups
- Think about the **best and worst** jobs you have personally had:
- What were their features as workplaces?
- What were the effects on your motivation, career development, accomplishments?



The Cybernetic Teammate: A Field Experiment on Generative AI and Teamwork by Fabrizio Dell'Acqua, Charles Ayoubi, Hila Lifshitz, Raffaella Sadun, Ethan Mollick, Lilach Mollick, Yi Han, Jeff Goldman, Hari Nair, Stew Taub, Karim R. Lakhani

This preregistered field experiment with 791 professionals at Procter & Gamble shows that AI can meaningfully enhance collaborative work: individuals using AI performed as well as two-person teams without AI, produced more balanced ideas across technical and commercial domains, and reported more positive emotional responses. The findings suggest that AI can replicate some benefits of human collaboration while also complementing it, especially by improving idea generation, bridging functional silos, and reshaping how expertise and social engagement appear in knowledge work

Only 21% of employees globally are engaged (Gallup, 2025)- indicative of leadership issues.



Career progression (Leslie and Van Velsor, 1996)

Challenges of living in interesting times

- **Planet**- climate change
- **Society**- global mobility, EDI, pandemics
- **Ethical**- AI and disruptive technologies, globalized workforce (and indecent work)
- **Geopolitics**- peace, justice, polarization and fake news/misinformation

Gehrke et al. (2024)



Our main goal: Learn how to improve organisational effectiveness and performance and organisation members' well-being while keeping in mind the interests of all stakeholders, in a changing global context.

Topics

Part 1: Introduction

- What Is the Future of Work?

Part 2: The Individual Level

- On Personality and understanding individual differences in work.
- Motivation and Emotions

Topics

Part 3: Decision Making and Group Processes

- Individual Decision Making,
- Foundations of Group Behaviour and work teams
- Conflict and Negotiation

Part 4: Diversity in Organizations

Part 5: The Organisation System

- Leadership
- Organisational Structure.
- Organisational Culture and Change

Module information

- Check timetable for class schedule
- Readings/resources in the handbook



Assessment

Assessment 1 - Continuous Assessment (40%) - Individual Written Report (2500 words +/- 10%), due 11th October 2026

- Interview 2 people in the food and beverage industry
- Identify key challenges covered in the module
- Write recommendations

Assessment 2 – Examination (60%), 25th October.

On my approach to teaching





Questions?

Learning Outcomes for this Session

- Understand how the **world of work and the nature of organisations** are changing
- Be aware of the **skills and knowledge** you are likely to need to be well prepared for this change.
- Use this knowledge to think about **your developmental needs and future career choices.**
- Begin to engage in effective group work

What do we mean by the term "Future of Work"

- The Future of Work is a projection of how work, working, workers and the workplace will evolve in the years ahead from the perspective of different actors in society, influenced by technological, socio-economic, political and demographic changes. (Lynn et al., 2023)
- Imprecise – involves guesswork
- The future is uncertain - Utopia or dystopia?
- Strong focus on digitisation, automation and analytics but associated social dynamics are equally important.
- A range of possible narratives (stories) viewed from a range of perspectives – positive and negative

How has the world of work changed for your great grandparents, grandparents and parents over the past 50 years?

What do they say?

Looking to the Past

- Need to consider where we have come from.
- Epochs:
  - Premodern – tribal, the clan, networks/alliances, feudal model
  - Modern (industrial, administrative bureaucracy, large scale, hierarchy, rule and procedure driven, technology)
  - Late Modern (current practices)
  - Post-modern – what is coming next- ?
- Modern Epoch:
  - On the line (1924) - https://youtu.be/BoGyx-CvdqA
  - Charlie Chaplin – Modern Times https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6n9ESFJTnHs
- Continuing trends (same but a bit different):
  - Foxconn - https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9XkX6EGk_CA
  - Call centre work - https://youtu.be/UAAwDKDRLTQ
- Shifts in control and structures.
- However, the past is not necessarily a good predictor of or guide to the future.

What is happening NOW to jobs and the nature of work?

Group Task 1 - Drivers
(Group Poster Output)

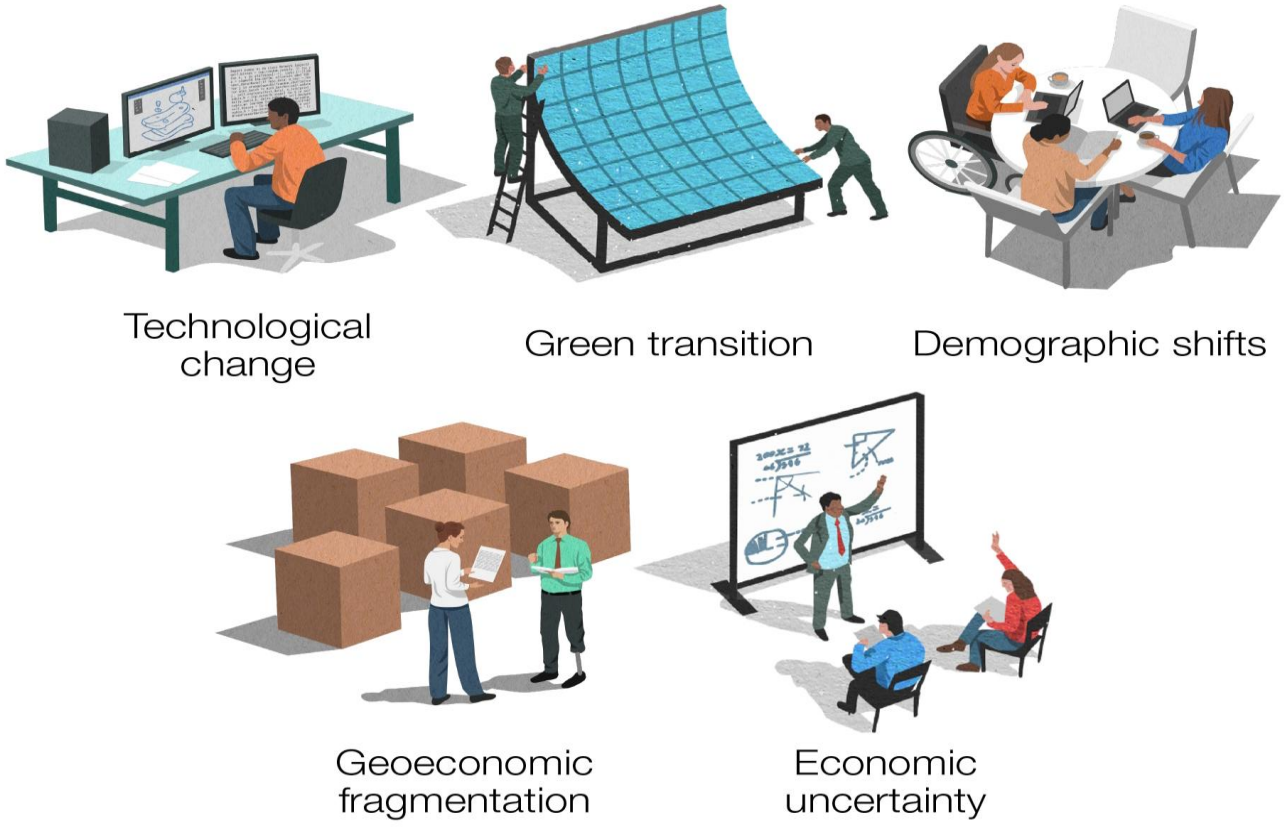
- Identify what you consider to be the key macro and external factors driving change in the nature of work today.
- Capture your work creatively and impactfully on your whiteboard.
- Prepare to screen share your whiteboard- take a screen shot.
- Choose one or two people to present the poster.

World Economic Forum
Future of Jobs Report 2025

- Global survey
- 1,000 employers surveyed – representing more than 14 million workers across 22 industry clusters and 55 different economies
- Insights into the emerging jobs landscape for the 2025-2030 period.

Future of Jobs Report 2025

Five key labour-market drivers

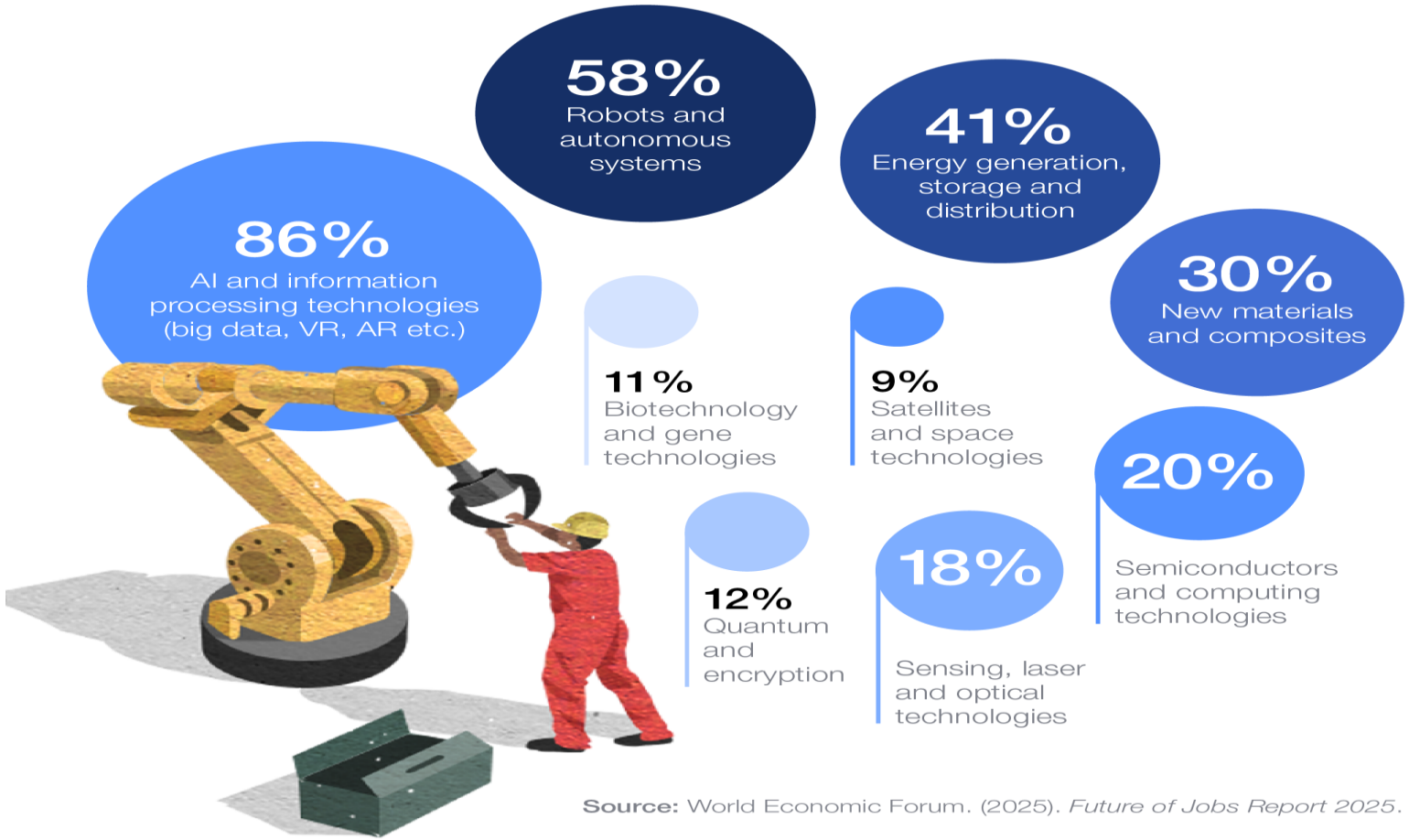


Source: World Economic Forum. (2025). *Future of Jobs Report 2025*.

Future of Jobs Report 2025

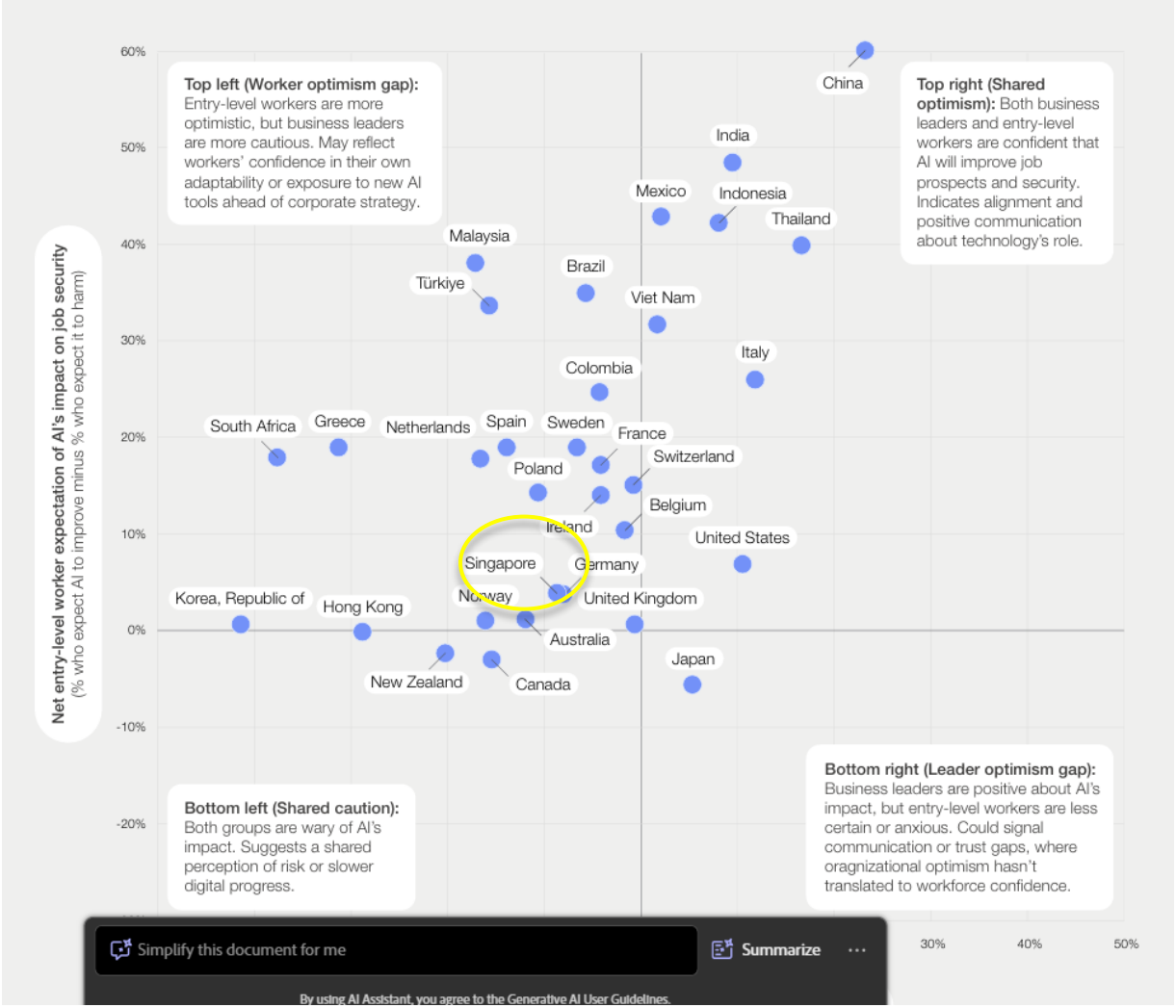
Trends in AI, robotics and energy technologies are most likely to drive business transformation

Share of employers expecting the technology to transform their organization



Source: World Economic Forum. (2025). *Future of Jobs Report 2025*.

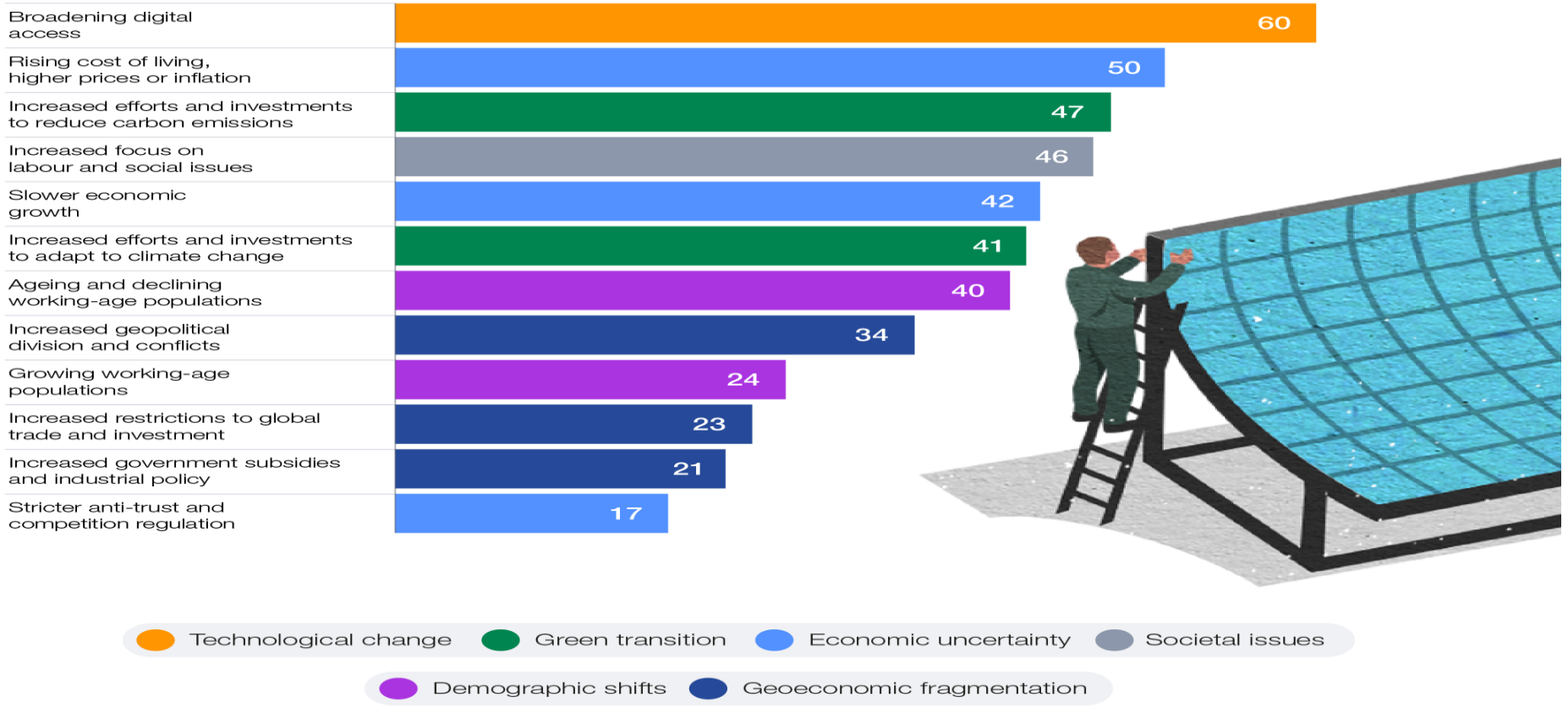
What are you optimistic about regarding AI and what are your concerns?



Future of Jobs Report 2025

Digital access, cost of living and green transition trends are driving business transformation

Share of employers surveyed that expect each macrotrend to drive organization transformation by 2030



Source: World Economic Forum. (2025). *Future of Jobs Report 2025*.

Future of Jobs Report 2025

Diversity, equity and inclusion (DEI) adoption is on the rise

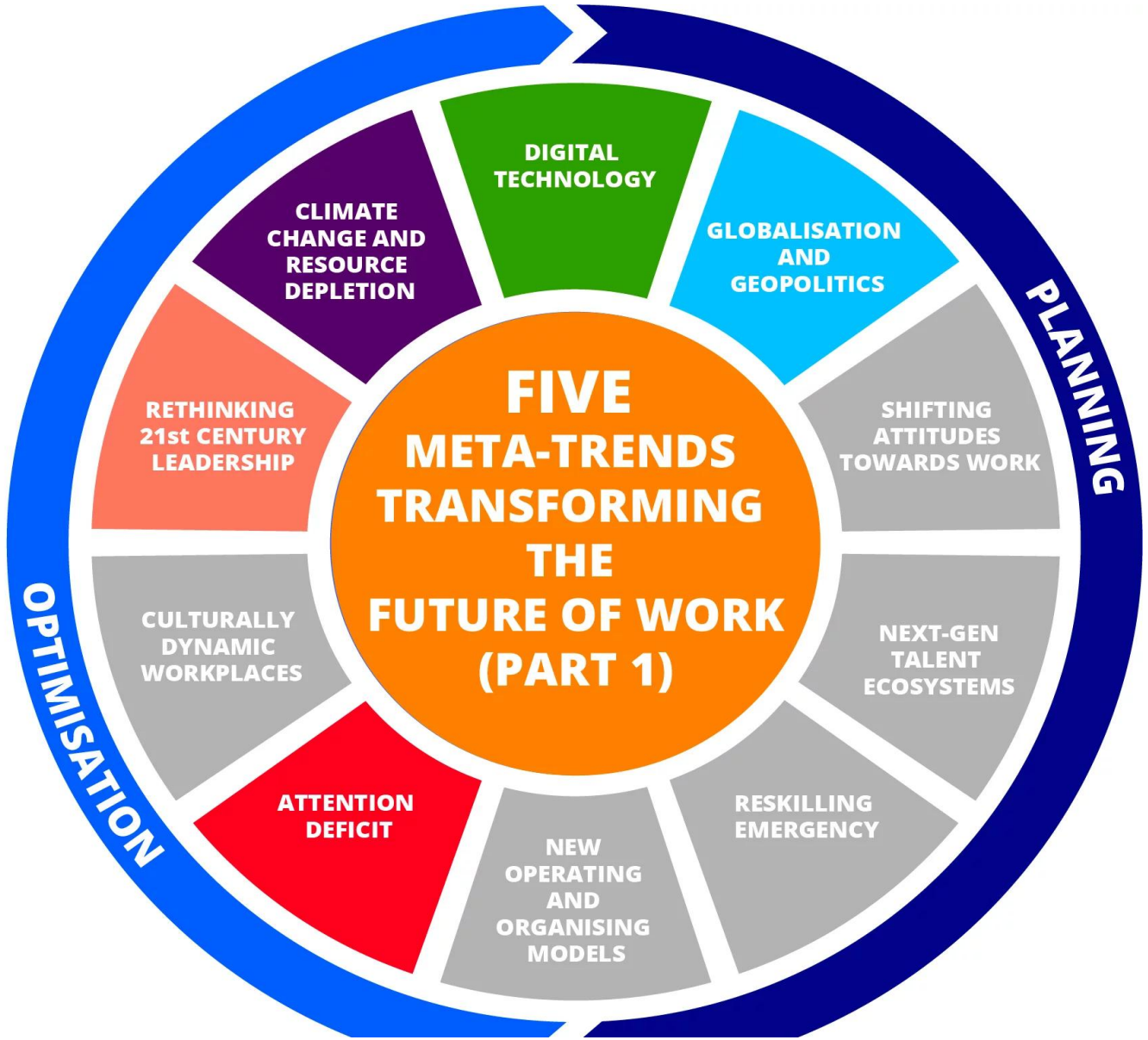
83% of employers have DEI priorities



Source: World Economic Forum. (2025). *Future of Jobs Report 2025*.



https://medium.com/@sidselloschenkohl/five-trends-shaping-the-future-of-work-dbbd5eda1ba9



https://workingthefuture.com/blog/post/

Group Task 2 - Occupations (Group Poster Output)

Tell me:

(a) the occupations or jobs you think will be both lost and most in demand by 2030. (Declining jobs V. Emerging jobs)

(b) What do you consider to be the Top Work Skills and forms of knowledge for 2030?

What % of the workforce are in occupations that are highly likely to grow as a share of the workforce by 2030?

Result: 10%

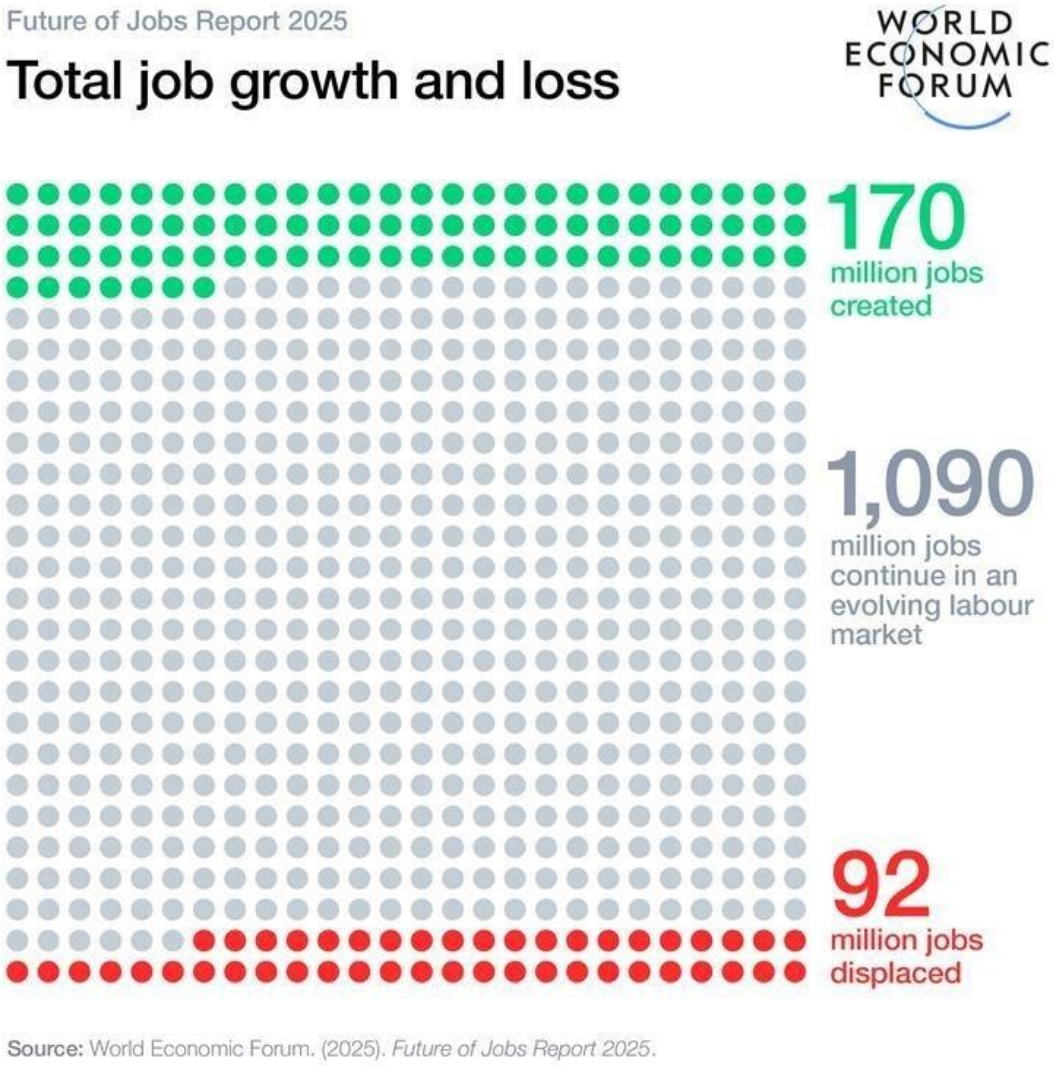
What % of the workforce are in occupations that are highly likely to shrink as a share of the workforce by 2030?

Result: 20%

Roughly what % of the workforce are in occupations where it is too uncertain to say what will happen to those jobs?

Result: 70%

Expected Job Growth and Decline (2025-2030)



Fastest growing vs. fastest declining jobs

Top 10 fastest growing jobs

1.	AI and Machine Learning Specialists
2.	Sustainability Specialists
3.	Business Intelligence Analysts
4.	Information Security Analysts
5.	Fintech Engineers
6.	Data Analysts and Scientists
7.	Robotics Engineers
8.	Big Data Specialists
9.	Agricultural Equipment Operators
10.	Digital Transformation Specialists

Top 10 fastest declining jobs

1.	Bank Tellers and Related Clerks
2.	Postal Service Clerks
3.	Cashiers and ticket Clerks
4.	Data Entry Clerks
5.	Administrative and Executive Secretaries
6.	Material-Recording and Stock-Keeping Clerks
7.	Accounting, Bookkeeping and Payroll Clerks
8.	Legislators and Officials
9.	Statistical, Finance and Insurance Clerks
10.	Door-To-Door Sales Workers, News and Street Vendors, and Related Workers

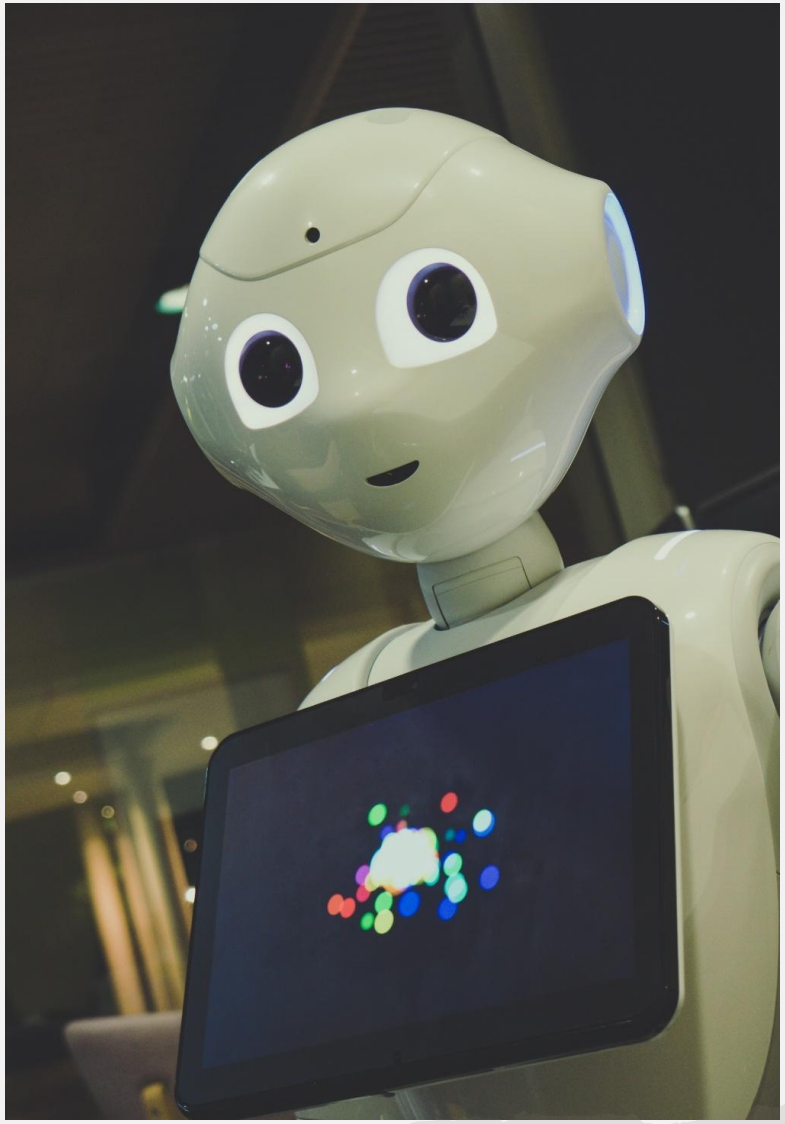
Source
World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Report 2023.

Note
The jobs which survey respondents expect to grow most quickly from 2023 to 2027 as a fraction of present employment figures

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EuDnSqAo784

Employment Skills for the Future

- Future employment trends through to 2030 are still uncertain.
- It is predicted that some jobs will grow as a share of the workforce, whilst others will shrink.
- Certain skills will be more in demand than others.
- To prepare for the future world of work, it will be beneficial for you to develop a mixture of the skills and knowledge that are likely to be in demand.



Future of Jobs

Reskilling needs

WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM

44%

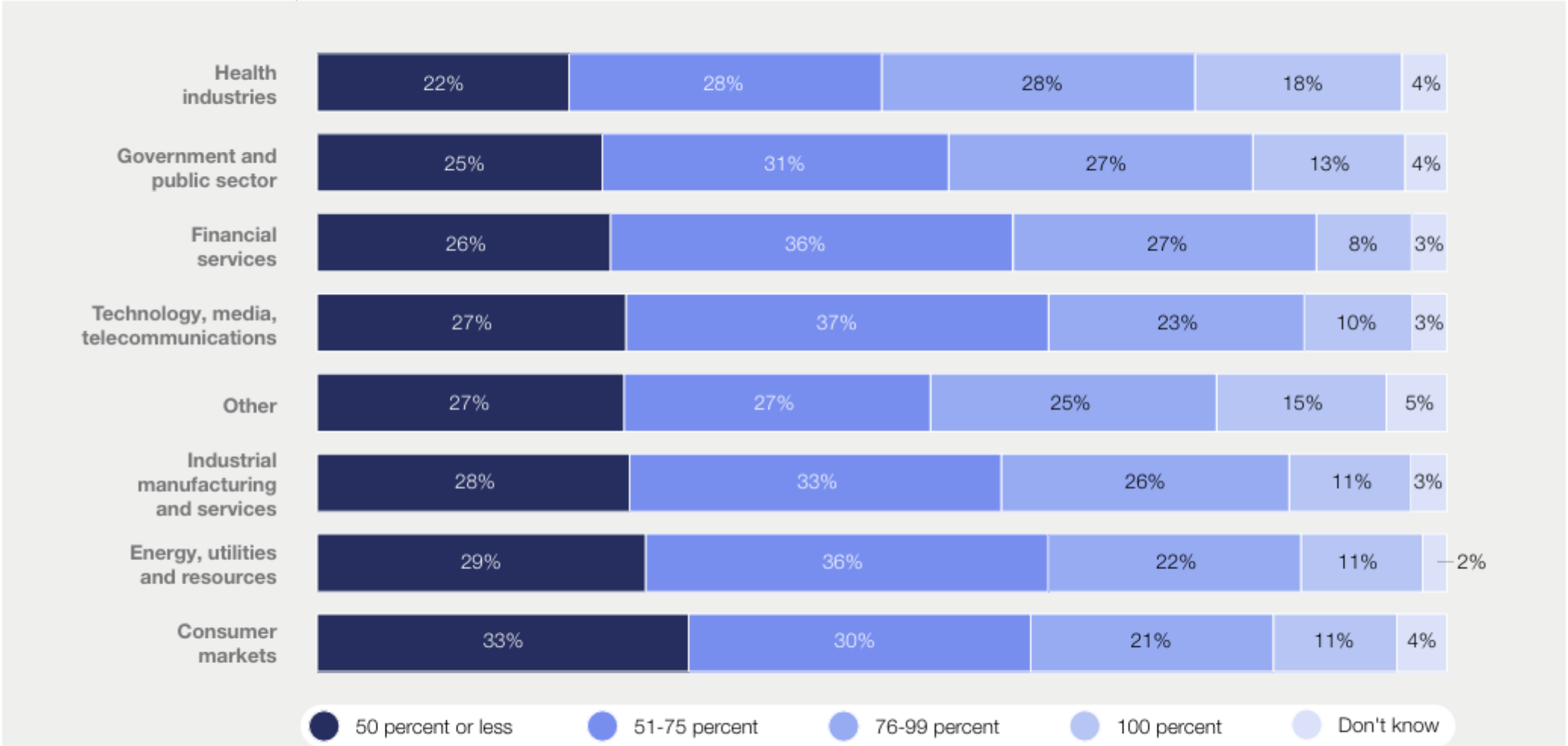
of workers' core skills are expected to change in the next five years



Source: World Economic Forum, *Future of Jobs Report 2023.*

FIGURE 4

Entry-level worker response to the question: "What proportion of the skills you have today will be relevant to the way you expect to work in three years' time?", by sector



Source

PwC, Global Workforce Hopes & Fears Survey, 2025.

Note

The percentages in the graph may not add up to 100% because values have been rounded up/down.

Skills and Knowledge for 2030 (NATA, @NATA_UK)

Interpersonal Skills:
Skills used to **interact** and **communicate** with other people.

- Ability to collaborate
- Understanding of others
- Teaching others

Learning Skills:
Skills used to learn **new knowledge** and behaviours.

- Setting goals
- Getting feedback
- Asking relevant questions

Specialised Knowledge:

- Science
- Technology
- Engineering
- Maths
- Foreign Languages

Higher Order Thinking Skills:
Advanced **thinking** skills which go **beyond** just **remembering facts**.

- Originality
- Active learning
- Range of ideas
- Complex problem solving
- Judgement and decision making

Broad-based knowledge:

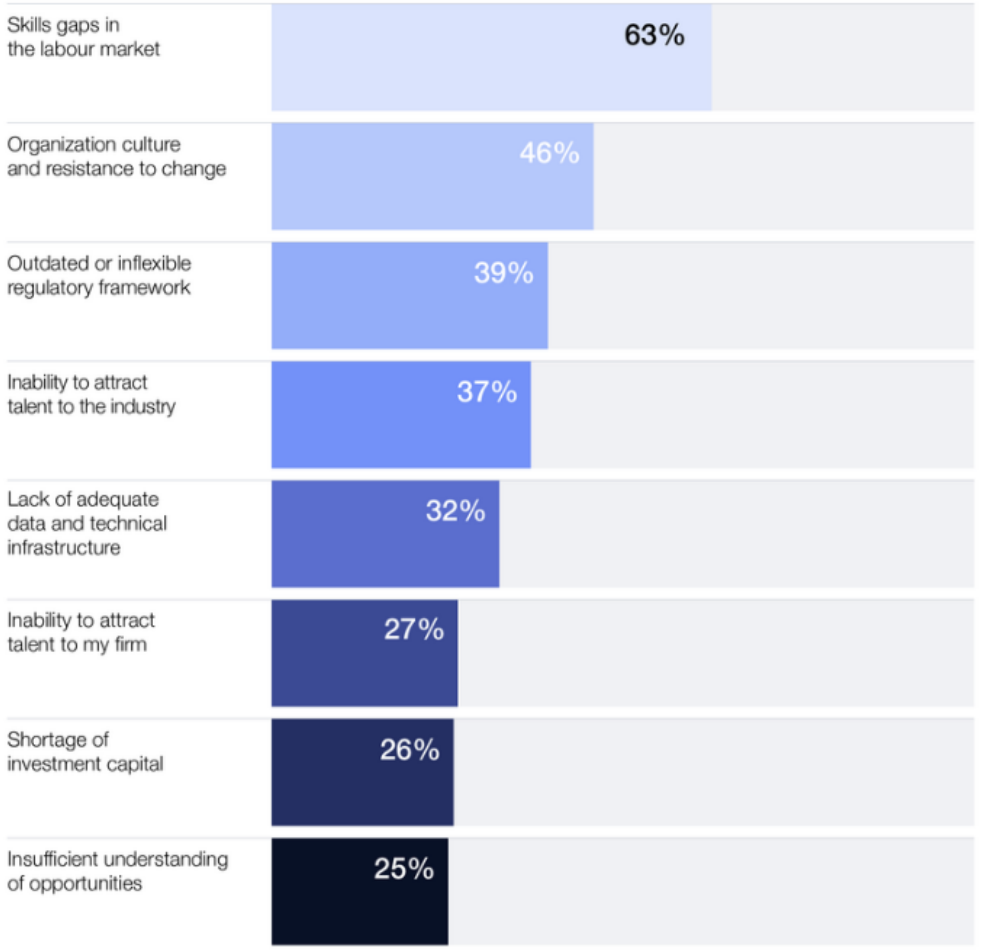
- English language
- History
- Management studies
- Philosophy

Future of Jobs Report 2025

Skills gaps prevent business transformation

WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM

Share of employers rating this as a main transformation barrier



Future of Jobs Report 2025

Core skills in 2025

1. Analytical thinking
2. Resilience, flexibility and agility
3. Leadership and social influence
4. Creative thinking
5. Motivation and self-awareness
6. Technological literacy
7. Empathy and active listening
8. Curiosity and lifelong learning
9. Talent management
10. Service orientation and customer service

Cognitive skills · Self-efficacy · Working with others · Management skills · Technology skills · Engagement skills

Note: The skills selected by surveyed organizations to be of greatest importance to workers at the time of the survey.

Source: World Economic Forum. (2025). *Future of Jobs Report 2025*.

Future of Jobs Report 2025

Top 10 fastest growing skills by 2030

1. AI and big data
2. Networks and cybersecurity
3. Technological literacy
4. Creative thinking
5. Resilience, flexibility and agility
6. Curiosity and lifelong learning
7. Leadership and social influence
8. Talent management
9. Analytical thinking
10. Environmental stewardship

Cognitive skills · Self-efficacy · Working with others · Management skills · Technology skills · Ethics

Human, socially-oriented skills remain critical

Analytical thinking remains the most sought after core skill among employers, with seven out of 10 companies considering it as essential in 2025. This is followed by resilience, flexibility and agility, along with leadership and social influence.

Skills rooted in human interaction – including empathy and active listening, and sensory processing abilities – and manual dexterity, endurance and precision, currently show no substitution potential due to their physical and deeply human components.

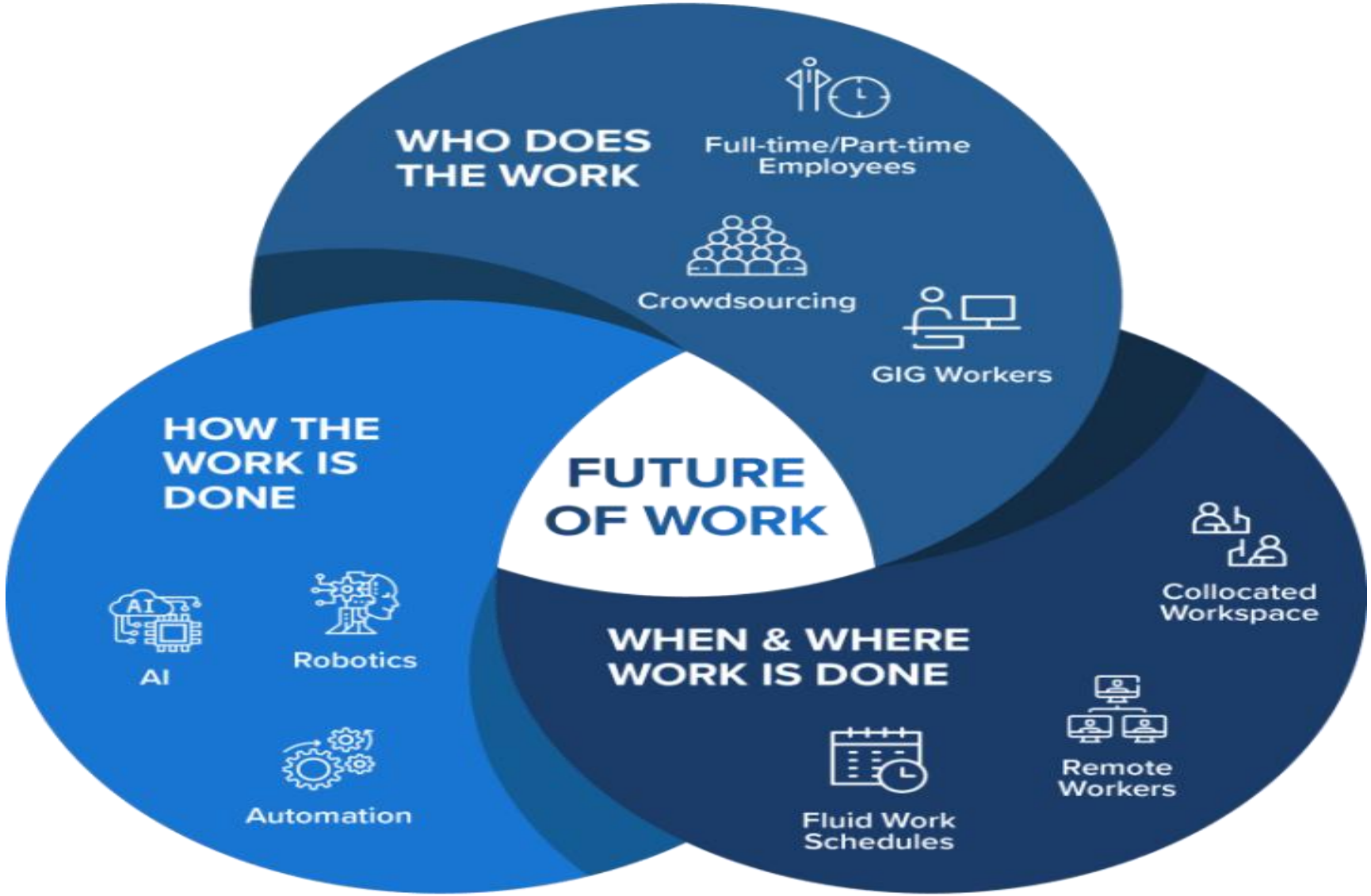
Skills requiring nuanced understanding, complex problem-solving or sensory processing show limited current risk of replacement by GenAI, affirming that human oversight remains crucial even in areas where GenAI can provide assistance.

Assessing your Skill Set – Are YOU Future Ready?

- Which skills are you currently most confident in?
- Why?
- Q. Are there any skill areas you are less confident in?
- Why?
- Q. What opportunities could your university provide to help you develop these skills further?
- Q. What opportunities are there outside of school to develop these skills further?

What is happening to and within Organisations?

What will organisations look like in the future?

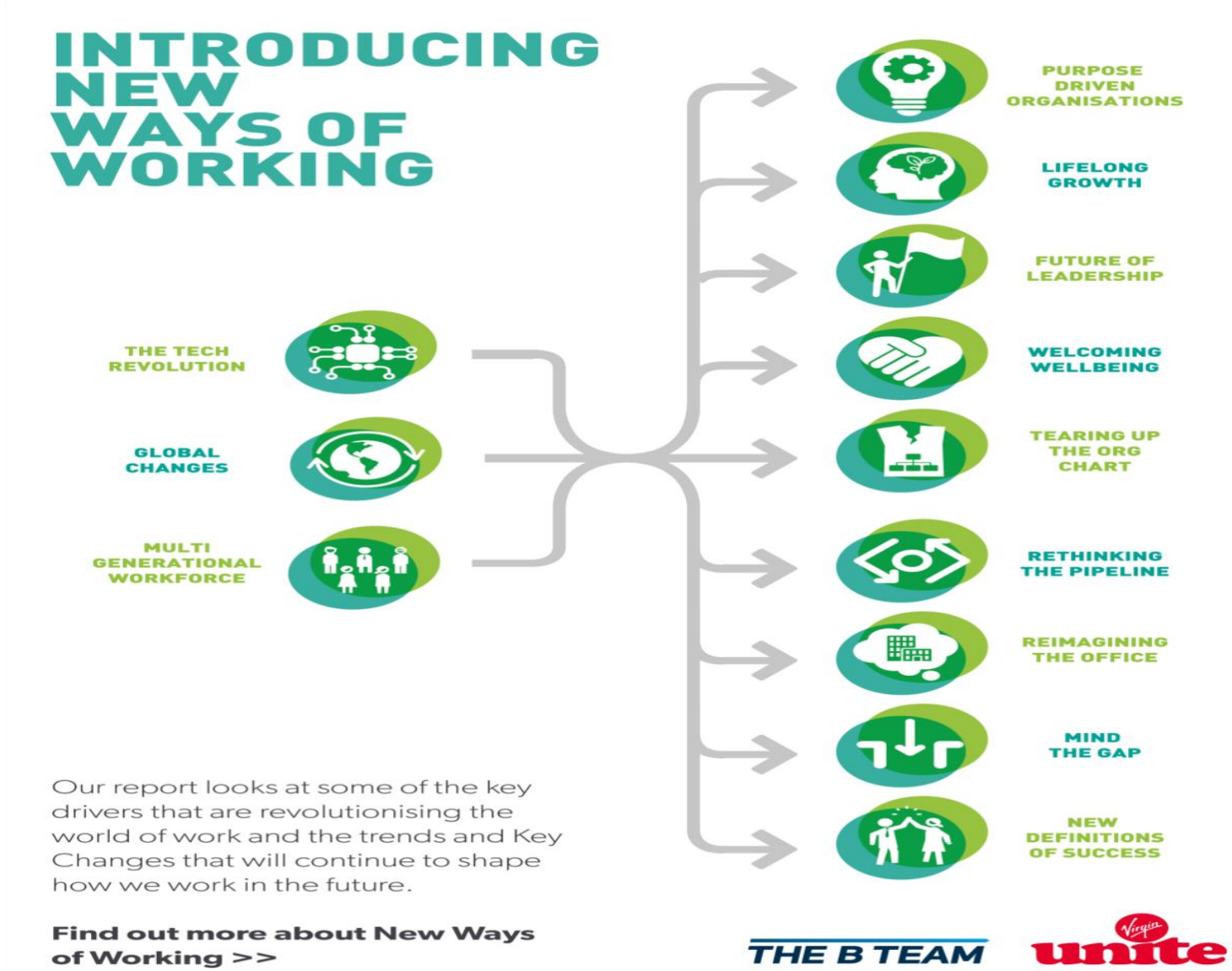


https://www.jobspikr.com/blog/future-employment-trends-and-predictions/

Group Task 3 – Making Organisations “Future Ready” (Group Poster Output)

- Find an Asian-based organization that through its design and practices you think points the way to the future.
- Identify what you consider to be three core features or dimensions of this future focused organization that make it special and “future ready”.
- It should not only focus on its use of technology or its core product.
- Prepare a summary poster for sharing with the class.

- Time: 25 mins



https://www.virgin.com/virgin-unite/latest/five-things-you-need-to-know-about-the-future-of-work

Key Trends in Organisational Design

- Increased agility - flattened hierarchy
- Hybrid work – virtual work
- New modes of collaboration – inside and out
- Decentralisation - Outcome-based management of small cross-functional teams
- Reskilling/talent acquisition
- Dispersed leadership

Traditional vs. Modern Job Architecture Models (Korn Ferry)

	Traditional Job Architecture	Modern Job Architecture
Structure	Fixed hierarchies with rigid levels	Flexible structures based on skills and competencies
Career Paths	Preset vertical progression	Multiple paths allowing vertical and horizontal movement
Skills Approach	Tied to specific roles and departments	Transferable across functions
Job Descriptions	Static descriptions tied to specific responsibilities	Dynamic profiles focused on capabilities
Compensation	Based on hierarchical levels	Aligned with skills and market value
Workforce Planning	Focus on replacing roles	Driven by future skills needs

Who has the Best Poster



- Grading criteria:
  - Comprehensive
  - Clear
  - Visually impactful and colourful
- Vote with your hand up

Concluding Thoughts

- Lots of change ahead.
- There will also be lots of continuity.
- Future is uncertain and unpredictable.
- Drivers for change will continue to evolve
- Need for adaptation in occupational mixes
- New skills and forms of knowledge coming to the fore- key skills remain human focused;
- Organisations need a future of work strategy
- You need to invest in your own development- life-long learning.

Reference Material

- Podcast: https://www.mckinsey.com/sg/our-insights/generative-ai-and-the-future-of-work-a-singapore-perspective
- Are Singaporeans ready for the future of work? Institute of Policy Studies 2023 - https://lkyspp.nus.edu.sg/docs/default-source/ips/ips-exchange-series-26.pdf
- https://www.mckinsey.com/featured-insights/mckinsey-explainers/what-is-the-future-of-work
- https://workingthefuture.com/resources-landing-page

Topic and Tasks for the Next session

- Topics:
  - Personality and individual difference.
  - Motivation and emotion
- Complete the online five factor model test and bring your results to class (link in the study guide).
- Review the listed readings on the study guide
- Bring pen and paper and laptop.